

HTTP ARCHIVE · STATE OF THE WEB

State of the Web 2020–2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

Data source: HTTP Archive continuous crawl · Time range: January 2020 – March 2026

Audience: Web performance engineers & front-end architects

~16M

Desktop URLs crawled

~12.5M

Mobile URLs crawled

6 yrs

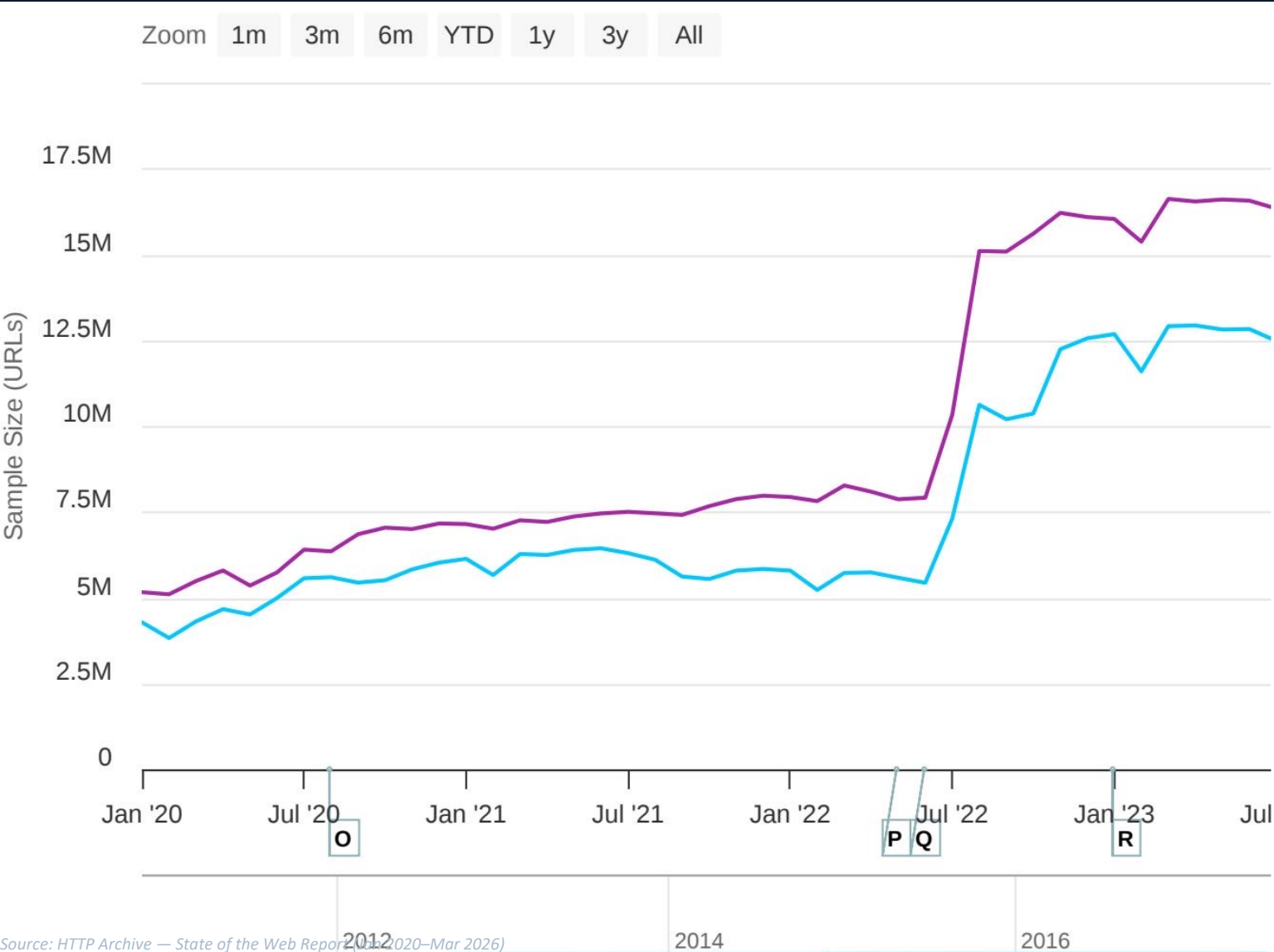
Observation window

5

Key trend areas

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive crawl coverage — desktop & mobile URL counts over time



Desktop URLs (2020 → 2025)

~5M → ~16M

Mobile URLs (2020 → 2025)

~3.5M → ~12.5M

Sharp jump mid-2022

Both lines ~doubled

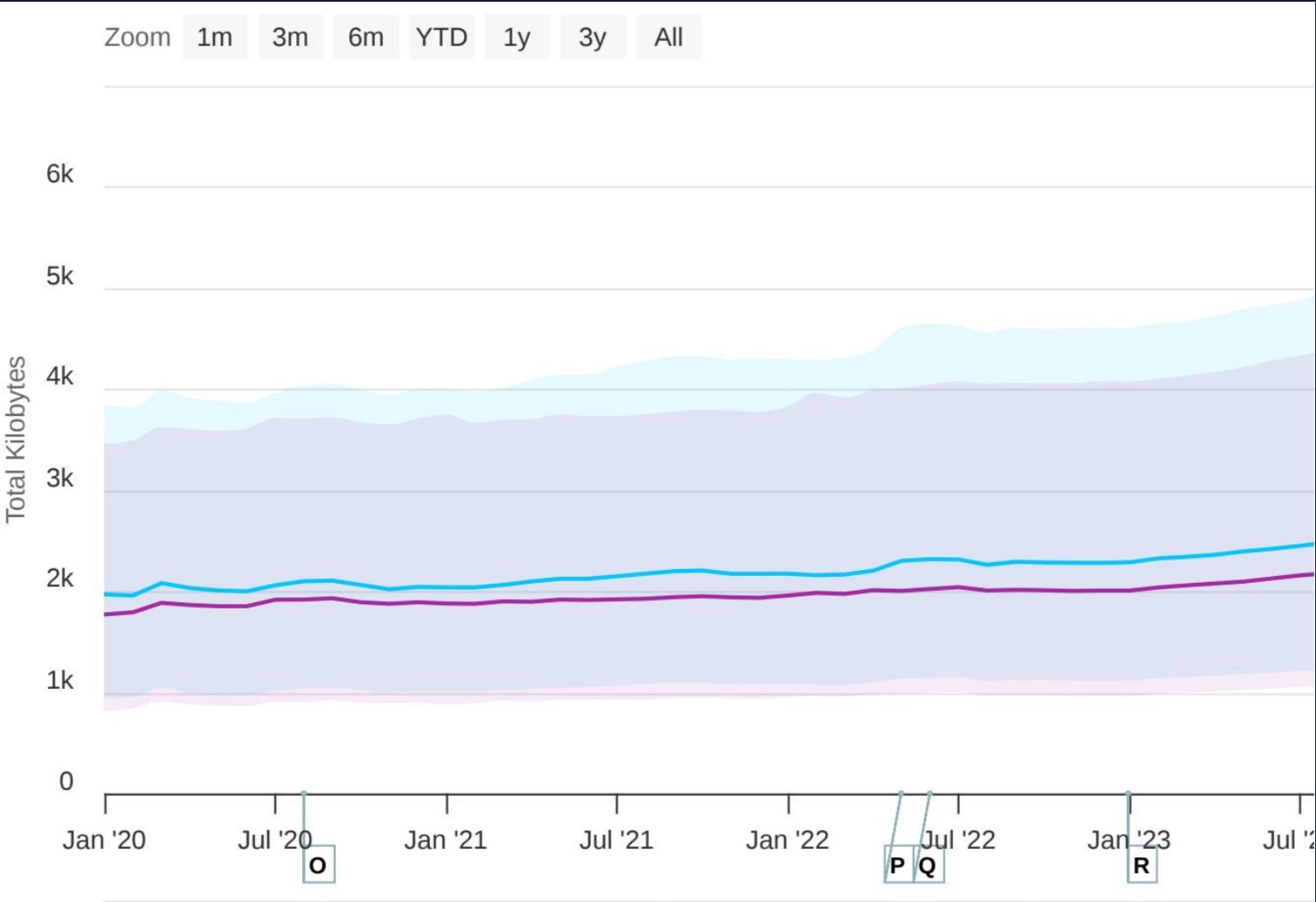
Post-2023 plateau

16M desktop / 12.5M mobile

3× growth in sample size improves statistical confidence in all derived metrics.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size (KB) — median with IQR variance bands



Desktop median (2025)

~2,000 KB

Mobile median (2025)

~1,900 KB

Desktop (2020 baseline)

~1,600 KB

5-year Δ (desktop/mobile)

▲ ~25%

75th pct desktop

>4,000 KB

Richer media & JavaScript continue to inflate page weight despite compression gains.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More resources, fewer connections — the multiplexing dividend

Median Requests / Page

76

Desktop ▲ 2.7%

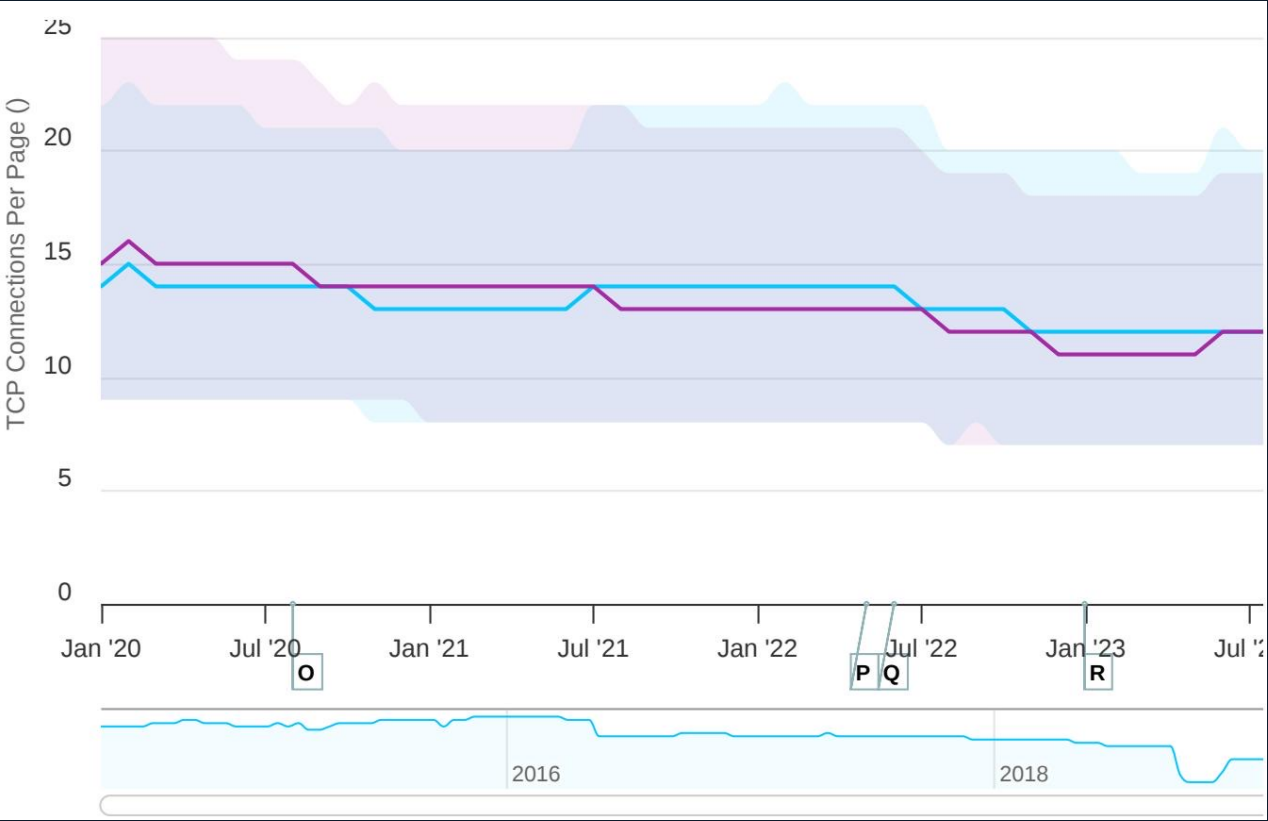
71 Mobile ▲ 2.9%

Median TCP Connections / Page

12

Desktop ▼ 14.3% (was ~15)

11 Mobile ▼ 26.7% (was ~15)



HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing allows many requests over a single TCP connection — cutting connections even as request counts rise.

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Share of HTTPS requests — desktop & mobile — Jan 2020 to Mar 2026

99%+

of all web requests
use HTTPS

Desktop

99.2%

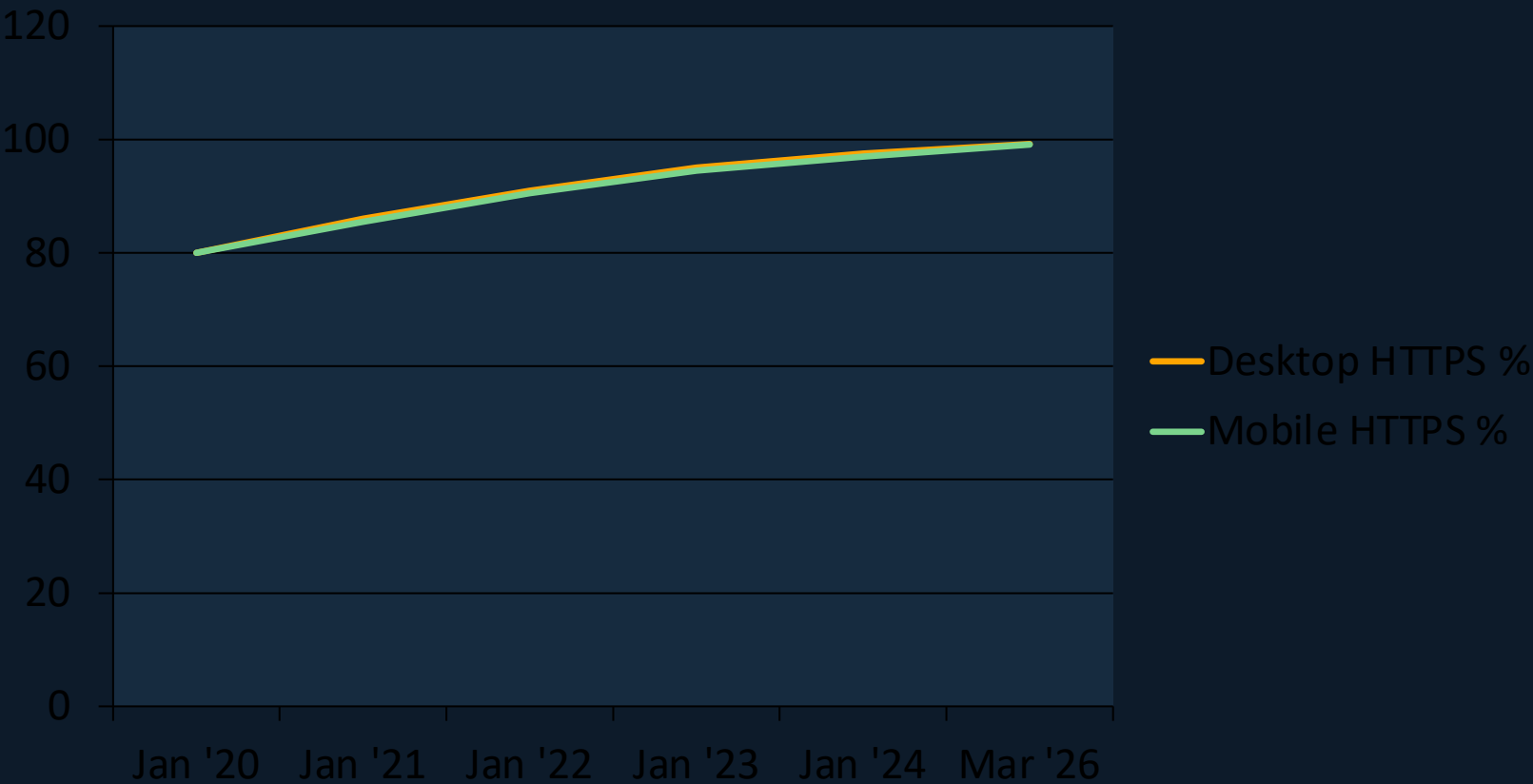
Mobile

99.1%

2020 baseline

~80%

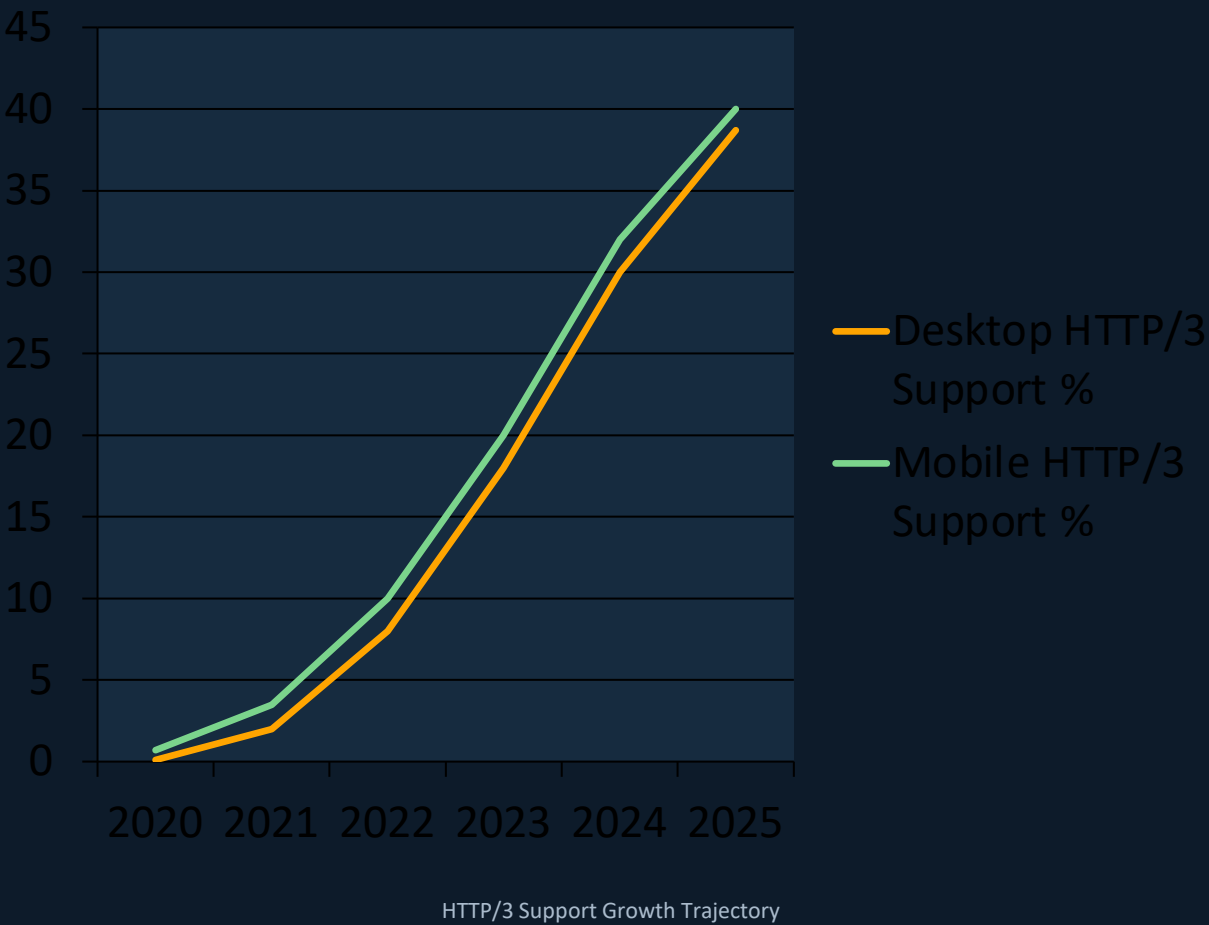
5-yr gain



Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web. Browser security indicators and HSTS preloading drove near-complete adoption.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

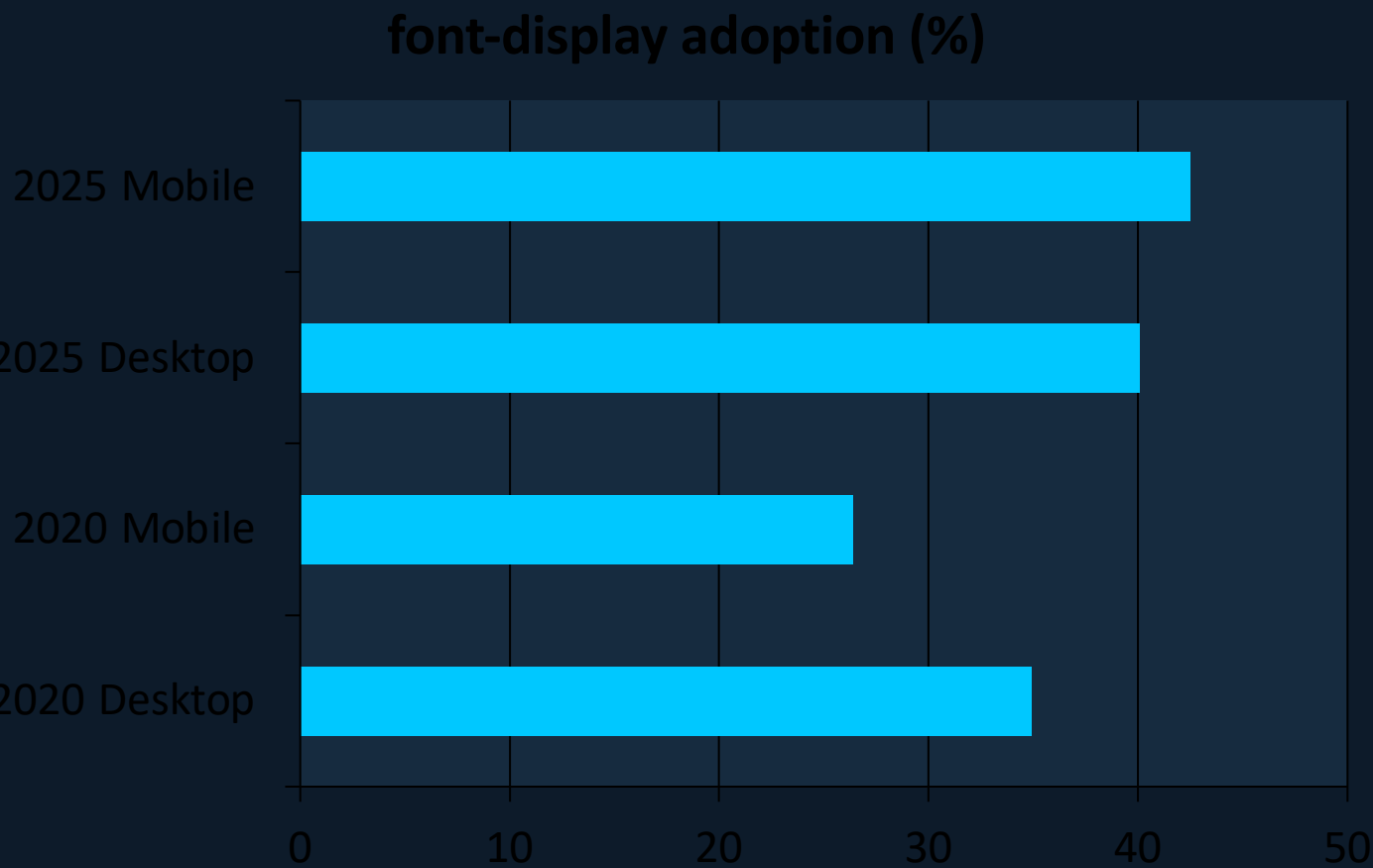
Protocol adoption snapshot (2025) and HTTP/3 growth trajectory



Measurement note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (via Alt-Svc header discovery), not actual usage. Fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection. Real HTTP/3 usage is lower than the support figure.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

CSS font-display adoption — desktop vs. mobile (Lighthouse audit, 2020–2025)



Desktop adoption (2025)

40.1%

Mobile adoption (2025)

42.5%

Desktop growth

+14.9%

Mobile growth

+61.0%

What is font-display?
A CSS descriptor that controls how a web font is displayed while loading. It prevents Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) — when text is hidden until the

Action: Audit web fonts for missing font-display declarations. Values 'swap', 'fallback', or 'optional' all prevent invisible text during font load.

Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages · Smarter Protocols · Stronger Security

Page Weight Keeps Climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — ~25% heavier than 2020. Richer media and JavaScript continue to inflate size despite compression improvements.

HTTPS Is the New Baseline

99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile requests are encrypted. Unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct. All new infrastructure should enforce HTTPS by default.

HTTP/3 Is the Fastest-Growing Protocol Metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years. Enable HTTP/3 (QUIC) on your origin and CDN to capture early-adopter performance gains.

Fewer TCP Connections Despite More Requests

Median connections fell 14–27% (now 12 desktop / 11 mobile) while requests rose ~3%. HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing is delivering measurable network efficiency.

Font-Display Still Underused

Only ~40–42% of pages use font-display. More than half risk FOIT. A one-line CSS fix can prevent invisible text for millions of users.

Call to Action: Benchmark your site against these baselines at httparchive.org/reports/state-of-the-web. Are your page weights, protocol adoption, and font-display usage ahead of the median?